AUDITS: INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL

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DOCUMENT HISTORY			
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01	Initial edition	02/07/2024	N/A
02	Modification according to AC036/24	03/22/2024	PNT-013.01
03	Change in Spika departments, update of annexes to accommodate Spika suppliers	02/06/2025	PNT-013.02
04	Clarification that an auditor cannot audit his or her own department, clarification of exceptions in supplier evaluation.	05/07 /2025	PNT-013.03

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1. Aim

The objective of this procedure is to define the way in which audits are carried out at Spika Tech, hereinafter SPIKA, which are necessary to verify the degree of compliance with the quality standards and regulations applicable to the departments that make up SPIKA as well as the suppliers that provide a good (product or service) to SPIKA, since the quality of SPIKA's products depends not only on the organization itself but also on all the materials and services that make up the manufactured product.

Three types of audits are distinguished throughout the procedure :

- GRADE 1: Internal , also known as self-inspections , where SPIKA departments are audited internally in order to periodically check the efficiency and effectiveness of the Quality Management System.
- GRADE 2: To suppliers: to various suppliers, regardless of the material to be supplied, as well as to various services, always impacting the quality of the products supplied. Evaluation questionnaires are also available as annexes to this procedure, through which an initial assessment is conducted to assess compliance with the desired quality standard.
- GRADE 3: External : those received by organizations, health authorities or official or private entities, to SPIKA

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all suppliers listed as having a potential impact on product quality and to departments involved in the production and maintenance chain of the Quality Management System.

3. Responsibilities and Departments Affected

It is the responsibility of all SPIKA staff to collaborate in the execution of internal audits.

It is the responsibility of the Responsible Technician to coordinate the correct execution of the internal and external audit plan, as well as the performance of the audits themselves.

Department	Apply	
	Yeah	No
Address	☒	☐
Environment	☒	☐
Quality Assurance	☒	☐
Systems and Cybersecurity	☒	☐
Research and Development	☒	☐
Marketing and Sales	☒	☐
Management	☒	☐

4. Definitions and Acronyms

- Non-Conformity (NC): An audit finding that does not meet a requirement specified in an audit criterion.
- Finding: The result of evaluating the audit evidence collected against audit criteria. Audit findings may indicate either conformity or nonconformity with audit criteria, as well as opportunities for improvement.
- Recommendation: A recommendation for improving quality, safety, or effectiveness. It does not constitute a deviation.
- CAPAs: Corrective Action Preventive Action

5. Procedure

5.1. Introduction

three types of audits are distinguished : internal, supplier and external.

The planning phases are:

- Preparation and planning : An agenda should be sent to the auditee and a date agreed upon.
- Audit execution : The audit will be carried out by management or the person delegated by the management, except for the audit of the technical department itself, which will be audited by a different department within the company or an external entity. Once the audit is completed, the observations detected should be discussed with the audited personnel.
- Report preparation : After execution, a corresponding report should be prepared. It is recommended to follow a clear format and follow the production flow of the processes to be reviewed. Compile the reviewed items and the observations with their classification. Any information deemed necessary for a proper understanding of the report may also be attached.
- CAPAs Plan : If observations are found that require resolution, a CAPAS plan will be generated and coding will be assigned according to PNT-006 Management of Corrective and Preventive Actions .

5.2. Grade 1: Internal Audits/Self-Inspections

The points to be reviewed in each area will depend on the type of activities carried out there. However, some aspects are common and should be taken into consideration in all areas subject to inspection, as applicable:

- The staff.
- Premises/ Facilities/ Equipment.
- Documentation: Standard Operating Procedures and Methods, Specifications, Manufacturing Guides, etc.
- Organization of the department or area.
- Validations of procedures.
- Processes.

It should be noted that self-inspections do not consist of an exhaustive and detailed review of each of the parts and activities that make up a specific department or area, but rather are based on the evaluation of a representative sample of the inspected process or area, and the deviations detected refer to what was observed.

5.2.1. Frequency

Self-inspections will be carried out at least once a year , although if necessary due to the severity or number of observations found, the frequency of implementation could be increased.

5.2.2. Audit staff

Self-inspections will be conducted by internal personnel unless the Technical Manager decides to subcontract them to a third party external to the organization. Auditing personnel must be trained in the company's procedures and have completed the qualifications included in Appendix 2. This record must be authorized by the Technical Manager before the audit is conducted. It will be kept in the Quality Assurance files. The selection of auditors must guarantee objectivity and impartiality in the audited area; therefore, auditors cannot audit their own work.

5.3. Grade 2: To suppliers

The supplier's impact must be previously assessed, the impact on product quality must be taken into account, therefore at least the following suppliers will be applicable, however, a recommendation for the evaluations is indicated, but a risk assessment document must be issued to define whether the audit is necessary or not, if such a document does not exist, the recommendation indicated below will be followed:

- Critical materials that make up the products manufactured at SPIKA.
- Other materials/services

It is recommended that the initial assessment questionnaires included in the annexes of this procedure be available in order to understand the auditee's quality system, although the supplier's own documentation may be available.

In cases where an on-site audit of the vendor is not possible (e.g., cloud service providers such as Google, Amazon, or Microsoft, SaaS software providers, or global mission-critical services providers), a justification for not performing an audit based on the risk analysis will be documented.

- Alternatively, the supplier may be evaluated by:
- Recognized certifications (e.g. ISO 27001, ISO 13485, SOC 2, etc.),
- Publicly available third-party audit reports,

- Specific contractual conditions (quality agreements, security or confidentiality clauses),
- Supplier document review, if applicable.

This evaluation must also be approved by the Responsible Technician and recorded as part of the supplier's evaluation file.

5.3.1. Frequency

In the table below the frequencies are determined based on

Type of material	Audit/Inspection Frequency
Critics	Every 3 years
No Critics	Every 5 years

The Responsible Technician will be the one who dictates the performance of a specific audit to a supplier according to needs, such as:

- New supplier
- Audited suppliers who have passed the audit period, re-evaluation of the supplier for other materials, detection of anomalies in the material or service provided, among others...

5.3.2. Audit staff

Audits will be conducted by internal personnel unless the responsible technician decides to subcontract them to a third party external to the organization. Audit personnel must be trained in the company's procedures and have completed the qualifications included in Appendix 2. This record must be authorized by the Responsible Technician before the audit is conducted. It will be kept in the Quality Assurance files.

5.4. Grade 3: External

External audits will be those in which an official or private body or entity audits SPIKA. Therefore, to the extent possible, given that they depend on a third party, they will be scheduled and it will be desirable to receive an agenda from that third party. However, it will be at the discretion of the auditors/inspectors to give advance notice and notify the corresponding visit.

Spika Tech will always be willing to accept audits when necessary, as a general rule, as a symbol of its commitment to the implemented quality system.

The nature and scope of the audit, as well as the classification of nonconformities, will be made available to the auditors/inspectors. Once the reports are received, SPIKA undertakes to assess the nonconformity and nonconfirmation in order to implement the appropriate corrective actions. This will be managed using procedure ***PNT-006, Management of Corrective and Preventive Actions****.*

5.5. Evaluation criteria for grade 1 and 2 audits.

For each of the Non-Conformities found during the audits, an assessment criterion will be established based on the severity of the non-conformity found as shown below:

Non-Conformity	Denomination	Description	Actions to take
Criticism (C)	Critical observation	Serious failures that constitute a serious breach of applicable regulations and pose a risk to product quality or data integrity.	Corrective measures must be taken IMMEDIATELY.
Major (M)	Important observation	Failures that, without affecting product quality or data integrity, constitute a minor breach of applicable regulations.	Corrective measures must be taken within a short period of time.
Minor (m)	Minor observation	Minor bugs, system improvements	Corrective measures must be taken within a specified timeframe.

Non-Conformity	Denomination	Description	Actions to take
Recommendations (R)	Recommendation	Comments for improvement in a specific area of the System, which does not reach the level of Non-Conformity, to be assessed by the auditee as to whether or not to consider implementing it.	Not applicable

5.6. Audit report

For the final issuance of the Audit Report, the auditing staff will have a maximum of three months from the date of the audit. If any of the nonconformities detected are Critical (C), these deadlines may be reduced in order to immediately correct the finding.

The reports will be coded as follows:

INTERNAL AUDIT	EXTERNAL AUDIT	Where:
AUD -INT-XX/YY	AUD-EXT-XX/YY	XX corresponds to the audit's consecutive number in the current year
		YY corresponds to the current year of the audit

The report numbers will be provided in the corresponding database under the custody of the responsible technician or the person delegated by him/her.

5.7. Documentation file

All documentation generated from audits will be managed according to PNT-001 Document and Archive Management.

6. Distribution of the Procedure

Staff members in the departments listed in Section 3 (Responsibilities and Affected Departments) must be provided with a copy of this procedure. In addition, controlled copy No. 1 will be submitted to the Archives for paper archiving.

Controlled copies to be issued:

Controlled Copy No.	Departments
1	Archive

7. Annexes

NO. / REV.	QUALIFICATION
1/01	Supplier Evaluation Questionnaire
2/01	Auditor qualification

8. Related documentation

Code	QUALIFICATION
MQ -01	Quality Manual
PNT-006	Management of corrective and preventive actions
PNT-001	Document and archive management

9. Training

This version requires that the affected departments indicated in section 3 receive the training indicated below:

Mark with an X	Type of training
☒	Theoretical (reading and understanding of the procedure)

☐	**Theoretical – Practical** (If you select this option, contact the Responsible Technician)

Annex 1_VERSION_03

Supplier Evaluation Questionnaire

General information

Company name:

Address:

Country:

Contact Phone / Email:

Responsible person / position:

Services offered:

Website:

Evaluation date:

General information and organization

Item	Supplier observations	SPIKA Observations
Brief description of the company and experience in the sector		
Do you have a documented organizational structure? (organizational chart)		
Do you have quality, security and data protection policies?		

Have you worked with companies in the healthcare or technology sectors?		

Legal compliance and certifications

Item	Supplier observations	SPIKA Observations
Is it legally incorporated and up to date with its tax obligations?		
Relevant certifications (ISO 27001, ISO 9001, ENS, etc.)		
Do you have standard contracts or NDAs?		

Information and systems security

Item	Supplier observations	SPIKA Observations
Do you apply access controls to critical information?		
Do you have active cybersecurity measures (firewalls, antivirus)?		

Do you perform regular backups? How often?		
Are the systems/software you use validated or tested?		

Software development and maintenance (if applicable)

Item	Supplier observations	SPIKA Observations
Development methodology used (Agile, Scrum, etc.)		
Do you document versions and changes to the delivered software?		
Do you offer corrective/evolutionary maintenance after delivery?		
Do you provide training or technical documentation to the client?		

Experience and references

Item	Supplier observations	SPIKA Observations
Main current or past clients		
Similar experiences in technological/health projects		
Success stories, case studies or other documents available		

Final evaluation

SPIKA Evaluator:

- Name:
- Post:
- Date:
- Signature:

Evaluation result:

☐Approved

☐Approved with conditions

☐Not approved

Annex 2_VERSION_03

Auditor qualification

Auditor's name					
Department					
Applicable regulatory reading					
Regulations	Filled				
RD 2017/745	☐				
ISO 13485	☐				
Training in applicable PNTs					
Document	Filled	Document	Filled	Document	Filled
Quality Manual	☐	PNT-001	☐	PNT-002	☐
PNT-003	☐	PNT-004	☐	PNT-005	☐
PNT-006	☐	PNT-007	☐	PNT-008	☐
PNT-009	☐	PNT-010	☐	PNT-011	☐
PNT-012	☐	PNT-013	☐	PNT-014	☐
PNT-015	☐	PNT-016	☐	PNT-017	☐
PNT-018	☐	PNT-019	☐	PNT-020	☐
PNT-021	☐	PNT-022	☐	PNT-023	☐
PNT-024	☐	PNT-025	☐	PNT-026	☐
PNT-027	☐				

Auditor qualification statement	Approval by the responsible technician
Signature and date	Signature and date